

# Job Hunt — Michael Kushman

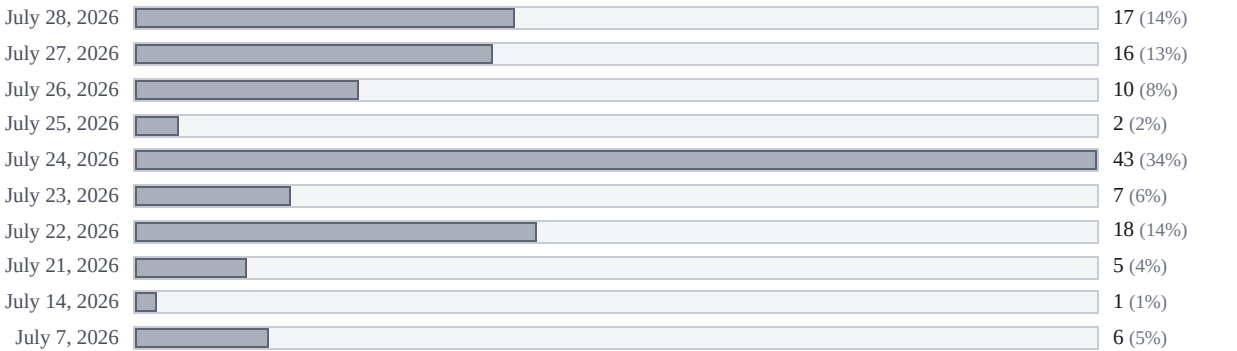
Verified application ledger · Gmail and Drive reconciled · simple tracker linked from the website

Updated July 28, 2026 — 125 verified applications · Runpoint confirmed receipt for AI Implementation Engineer and requested an automated Loom next step · 60 ATS confirmations · 2 human replies · 6 rejections · 1 live conversation

|                 |                      |               |                       |            |             |         |
|-----------------|----------------------|---------------|-----------------------|------------|-------------|---------|
| 125             | 60                   | 2             | 1                     | 6          | 5           | 4       |
| APPLICATIONS IN | ATS<br>CONFIRMATIONS | HUMAN REPLIES | LIVE<br>CONVERSATIONS | REJECTIONS | IN PIPELINE | BACKLOG |

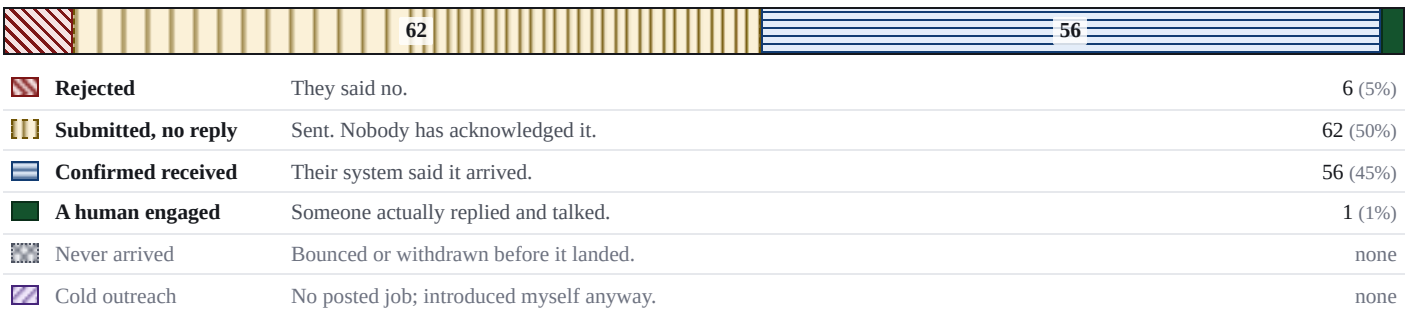
## How many went out, by day

125 verified applications across 10 active days. Bars are to scale against the busiest day.



## Where all 125 stand today

Every status carries its own label, count and fill pattern — the chart is readable in black and white, and colour is never the only cue.



## How the applications were sent

Read from the notes column. “Not recorded” means the note does not say how it went out — it is shown, not hidden, because it is a real share of the ledger.



### Why the confirmation numbers differ

The scoreboard says 60 ATS confirmations, but only 56 rows below currently read “Confirmed received.” Both are correct. 60 is *cumulative* — every confirmation ever received. The ledger shows *current state*, and 4 of those confirmations (Rillet and Tsenta) were superseded by a later outcome, so those rows now show that outcome instead. Nothing was lost and nothing was double-counted.

**What counts:** Submitted applications and delivered live-role emails count; drafts, bounces, opened forms, research, speculative outreach, and duplicate resends do not.  
**Standing rules:** Deduplicate by company, role, and earliest submission date. Resends update the existing row; distinct roles at the same company remain separate.

# The full ledger

All 125 verified applications, newest day first. Each entry carries its status in words, plus the channel it went out through.

| COMPANY                                                                                                                   | ROLE                                                     | COMPENSATION                  | LOCATION                                  | STATUS                                                                                                    | DATE |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| JULY 28, 2026 — 17 VERIFIED                                                                                               |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Albert</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                                                                              | Full Stack Software Engineer                             | —                             | —                                         |  Submitted, no reply   | 7/28 |
| Direct email to hello@albert.io · résumé attached; no bounce                                                              |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Buildout</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                              | (Senior) Software Engineer                               | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received    | 7/28 |
| Ashby confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the (Senior) Software Engineer role                                    |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Clarium</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                               | AI Engineer - Data Intelligence                          | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received    | 7/28 |
| Ashby confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the AI Engineer - Data Intelligence role                               |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Clover Health</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                         | UX Engineer                                              | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received    | 7/28 |
| Greenhouse confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the UX Engineer role                                              |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Ethena</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                                                                              | Sales Engineer                                           | —                             | —                                         |  Submitted, no reply   | 7/28 |
| Direct email to jobs@goethena.com · résumé attached; no bounce · jobs.lever.co                                            |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Hovercraft</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                            | Role not stated (Greenhouse confirmation)                | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received    | 7/28 |
| Greenhouse confirmation 7/28 · receipt omitted the role title; deliberately not inferred                                  |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Maple</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                                 | Design Engineer                                          | \$120–250K + equity and bonus | New York City, on-site five days per week |  Confirmed received    | 7/28 |
| Ashby confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the Design Engineer role                                               |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Maven Clinic</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                          | Product Designer, Maternity Experience                   | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| Greenhouse confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the Product Designer, Maternity Experience role                   |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Modern Classrooms Project</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                                                           | Role not stated (ApplyToJob confirmation)                | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| ApplyToJob confirmation 7/28 · receipt omitted the role title; deliberately not inferred                                  |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Mostest</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                               | Applied AI Engineer ( Remote - North American Timezones) | —                             | Remote - North American Timezones         |  Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| Ashby confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the Applied AI Engineer ( Remote - North American Timezones) role      |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>OpenSesame</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                                                                          | Role not stated (OpenSesame confirmation)                | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| Confirmation 7/28 · receipt omitted the role title; deliberately not inferred                                             |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Runpoint</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                                                                            | AI Implementation Engineer                               | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| Runpoint confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the AI Implementation Engineer role · automated Loom step requested |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Skiffra</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                               | Founding Frontend Engineer (AI-Native)                   | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| Ashby confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the Founding Frontend Engineer (AI-Native) role                        |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Stacklok</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                                                                            | Software Engineer II — Platform                          | —                             | —                                         |  Submitted, no reply | 7/28 |
| Direct email to hello@stacklok.com · résumé attached; no bounce · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Timely Schools</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>                                                        | Product Designer                                         | —                             | —                                         |  Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| Ashby confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the Product Designer role                                              |                                                          |                               |                                           |                                                                                                           |      |

| COMPANY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ROLE                                       | COMPENSATION                  | LOCATION                            | STATUS                | DATE |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------|------|
| <b>Voltus</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Software Engineer                          | —                             | —                                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Lever confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the Software Engineer role                                                                                                                                         |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Waymark</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Junior Software Engineer                   | —                             | —                                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/28 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Greenhouse confirmation 7/28 · receipt explicitly names the Junior Software Engineer role                                                                                                                             |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>JULY 27, 2026 — 16 VERIFIED</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Bjak</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Role not stated (Ashby confirmation)       | —                             | —                                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Ashby confirmation 7/27 · receipt omitted the role title; deliberately not inferred · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                                                                                                |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Customer.io</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Senior Software Engineer, Full Stack       | \$150–200K                    | Remote · Americas                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Greenhouse confirmation 7/27 · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                                                                                                               |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Dench.com</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Founding Engineer                          | —                             | —                                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| YC BOARD Applied via Work at a Startup (YC) · confirmation 7/27                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Govstream</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Senior Software Engineer                   | \$150–180K + eq               | Remote US · Seattle preferred       | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/27 |
| DIRECT EMAIL Direct email to chris.duranti@govstream.ai · résumé attached; no bounce · elixirforum.com                                                                                                                                           |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Herald</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Role not stated (Greenhouse confirmation)  | —                             | —                                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Greenhouse confirmation 7/27 · receipt omitted the role title; deliberately not inferred                                                                                                                              |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Jukebox Health</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Role not stated (Greenhouse confirmation)  | —                             | —                                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Greenhouse confirmation 7/27 · receipt omitted the role title; deliberately not inferred · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                                                   |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Livefront</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | AI Solutions Engineer                      | \$130–175K                    | Remote USA                          | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Greenhouse confirmation 7/27 · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                                                                                                               |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Mitty / Pineapple Hi</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | First Engineer                             | \$150K+ + bonus + founding eq | Honolulu, HI · remote-friendly      | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/27 |
| DIRECT EMAIL Direct email to Devin@pineapplehi.com · résumé attached; no bounce · mitty.film                                                                                                                                                     |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Moment</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Design Engineer                            | \$175–275K                    | NYC · on-site 5d/wk                 | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Ashby confirmation 7/27 · moment.com                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>ResortPass</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Senior Software Engineer, Frontend         | \$170–210K + eq               | Flatiron, NYC · on-site             | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Greenhouse confirmation 7/27 · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                                                                                                               |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Sailor Health</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Founding Engineer                          | —                             | —                                   | ☑ Confirmed received  | 7/27 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM Ashby confirmation 7/27                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Smartsheet</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Software Engineer – Frontend               | \$150–175K                    | Remote US · reports to Bellevue, WA | 🚫 Rejected            | 7/27 |
| DIRECT EMAIL Direct email to apply@smartsheet.com · Ad Code PTBS · Justin Naughton replied by hand 7/28 — “we will be moving forward with candidates whose profiles are closer aligned with our current hiring needs” · job-boards.greenhouse.io |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>Symetra</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Role not stated (direct application email) | —                             | —                                   | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/27 |
| DIRECT EMAIL Direct email to elliot.wargo@symetra.com · AI Enablement team; formal role not stated · résumé attached · symetra.com                                                                                                               |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |
| <b>TrashLab</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Product Engineer                           | —                             | San Francisco · hybrid              | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/27 |
| DIRECT EMAIL Direct email to john@trashlab.io · résumé attached; no bounce                                                                                                                                                                       |                                            |                               |                                     |                       |      |

| COMPANY                     | ROLE                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | COMPENSATION        | LOCATION                         | STATUS                | DATE |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|------|
| WireScreen                  | Senior Software Engineer (Frontend)                                                                                                                                                                                                | \$170–220K + eq     | NYC · hybrid                     | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/27 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to leo.green@wirescreen.ai · résumé attached; no bounce · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                                                                                                                            |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| WME                         | Senior Software Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                           | \$150–200K          | Remote · NY and select states    | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/27 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to tkuhl@wmegrp.com · résumé attached; no bounce · wmeimg.wd1.myworkdayjobs.com                                                                                                                                       |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| JULY 26, 2026 — 10 VERIFIED |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Aurorin CAD                 | Founding Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | \$120–160K + 3–4%   | San Francisco, CA                | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/26 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM  | Applied via Polymer · successful submission confirmed · ycombinator.com                                                                                                                                                            |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Awell Health                | Product Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | \$100–180K + eq     | Remote · US-time-zone hours      | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/26 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to careers@awellhealth.com · corrected resend added résumé · counted once · awellhealth.com                                                                                                                           |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Eagle                       | Design Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | \$150–300K + eq     | NYC · on-site                    | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/26 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to tom@eagleeng.com · résumé attached · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                                                                                                                                              |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Guac                        | Fullstack Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | \$150–250K + 0.5–1% | NYC · on-site 5d/wk              | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/26 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to jack@guac-ai.com · résumé attached · ycombinator.com                                                                                                                                                               |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| InstaLILY AI                | Design Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | \$100–120K + eq     | NYC                              | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/26 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM  | Greenhouse confirmation received · moved from backlog · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                                                                                                   |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Outmarket                   | Front-End AI Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Competitive + eq    | Remote · US or India             | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/26 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to careers@outmarket.ai · delivered; Gmail metadata shows no attachment · outmarket.ai                                                                                                                                |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| PrairieLearn                | Full-Stack Software Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                       | \$100–180K + eq     | Remote US                        | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/26 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM  | Ashby confirmation received · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                                                                                                                                                                     |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Profound                    | Design Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | \$120–250K          | NYC / Buenos Aires · on-site     | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/26 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to dylan@tryprofound.com · résumé attached · tryprofound.com                                                                                                                                                          |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| ProxyBase                   | Full-Stack Developer                                                                                                                                                                                                               | \$100–160K + eq     | Remote global                    | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/26 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to jobs@proxybase.xyz · role-specific pitch delivered; Gmail metadata shows no attachment · proxybase.xyz                                                                                                             |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Sylience (Chord)            | Founding Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | \$100–150K + 1–5%   | Remote · US time zones           | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/26 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Direct email to careers@sylience.com · delivered; Gmail metadata shows no attachment · sylience.com                                                                                                                                |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| JULY 25, 2026 — 2 VERIFIED  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| Counterpart                 | Product Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | \$110K+ est.        | Remote US                        | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/25 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM  | Greenhouse confirmation received · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                                                                                                                        |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| elly                        | Role not stated (Greenhouse confirmation)                                                                                                                                                                                          | —                   | —                                | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/25 |
| COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM  | Greenhouse receipt proves submission but omits title · role deliberately not inferred · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                                                                   |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| JULY 24, 2026 — 43 VERIFIED |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                     |                                  |                       |      |
| AIRE                        | Founding Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | \$100–250K + eq     | Remote US/Canada · NYC preferred | ❌ Rejected            | 7/24 |
| DIRECT EMAIL                | Passed 7/27 — Ashley at Sage Recruiting replied by hand: not a fit for the current role, keeping him on their hotlist for future openings · FIRST human reply of the campaign · cold email to recruitment@aire.xyz 7/24 · aire.xyz |                     |                                  |                       |      |

| COMPANY                                                                                                       | ROLE                                      | COMPENSATION     | LOCATION                    | STATUS                                                                                                          | DATE |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Arterial</b><br><div>NOT RECORDED</div>                                                                    | Junior Full-Stack Engineer                | —                | Remote US                   |  <b>Confirmed received</b>   | 7/24 |
| Application receipt confirmed materials and role · arterial.us                                                |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Atria Health</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                | Staff Software Engineer, Agentic AI       | \$230–290K       | NYC hybrid · Tue–Thu        |  Submitted, no reply         | 7/24 |
| Direct email to talent@atria.org delivered · auto-reply directed candidates to site · apply.workable.com      |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Avery</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                       | Software Engineer                         | —                | On-site / Remote US         |  Submitted, no reply         | 7/24 |
| Direct email to info@averyiq.com · delivered; no bounce · averyiq.com                                         |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Catalyst Wayfare</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                            | AI Engineer / Agent Builder               | —                | Remote US · Eastern overlap |  Submitted, no reply         | 7/24 |
| Direct email to talent@cwai.co · delivered; no bounce · catalystwayfare.ai                                    |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Colonist</b><br><div>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</div>                                                      | Product Engineer                          | —                | —                           |  <b>Rejected</b>             | 7/24 |
| Ashby confirmation 7/24 · rejection 7/27 — 'decided to move forward with other candidates' · jobs.ashbyhq.com |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Cora AI</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                     | Founding Full Stack / Applied AI Engineer | \$190–250K + eq  | Remote US / SF              |  Submitted, no reply         | 7/24 |
| Direct email to careers@cora.ai · moved from backlog · cora.ai                                                |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>DearHiringManager.io</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                        | Full-Stack Developer                      | \$120–160K       | Remote · US/EU time zones   |  Submitted, no reply         | 7/24 |
| Direct email to lars@dearhiringmanager.io · delivered; no bounce · dearhiringmanager.io                       |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Deployment.io</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                               | Forward Deployed Engineer                 | Competitive + eq | Remote US or India          |  Submitted, no reply         | 7/24 |
| Direct email to jobs@deployment.io 7/24 · resent 7/26 · counted once · deployment.io                          |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>DwellSafe</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                   | Full-Stack Engineer                       | —                | —                           |  Submitted, no reply        | 7/24 |
| Direct email to careers@dwellsafe.ai · delivered; no bounce · dwellsafe.ai                                    |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Emergences</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                  | AI / Systems Engineer                     | \$120–150K + eq  | Remote US                   |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/24 |
| Direct email to jack@emergences.ai · delivered; no bounce · emergences.ai                                     |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Ephanti</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                     | Founding Engineer, Agentic AI             | —                | Remote US/EU                |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/24 |
| Direct email to careers@ephanti.com · delivered; no bounce · ephanti.com                                      |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>FanShares</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                   | Founding Engineer                         | \$150–200K + eq  | United States               |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/24 |
| Direct email to leon@fansharesapp.com · delivered; no bounce · fansharesapp.com                               |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Hermes Web</b><br><div>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</div>                                                    | Founding Engineer                         | —                | Remote worldwide            |  <b>Confirmed received</b> | 7/24 |
| Open Core Ventures · Greenhouse confirmation 7/24 (as Open Core Ventures) · job-boards.greenhouse.io          |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Hightouch</b><br><div>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</div>                                                     | Role not stated (Greenhouse confirmation) | —                | —                           |  <b>Confirmed received</b> | 7/24 |
| Greenhouse confirmation 7/24 · receipt omitted the role title; deliberately not inferred · hightouch.com      |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Hotwash</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                     | Founding Engineer                         | —                | Remote US · Boston a plus   |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/24 |
| Direct email to hiring@hotwash.com · delivered; no bounce · hotwash.com                                       |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>JustiGuide</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                  | Frontend Engineer                         | —                | —                           |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/24 |
| Direct email to careers@justiguide.com · delivered; no bounce · justiguide.com                                |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Kadoa</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                       | Senior Software Engineer                  | —                | Fully remote                |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/24 |
| Direct email to adrian@kadoa.com · delivered; no bounce · kadoa.com                                           |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |
| <b>Kanary</b><br><div>DIRECT EMAIL</div>                                                                      | Full Stack Engineer                       | —                | Remote US · Seattle hub     |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/24 |
| Direct email to steven@kanary.com · delivered; no bounce · kanary.com                                         |                                           |                  |                             |                                                                                                                 |      |

| COMPANY                                                          | ROLE                                                                                                          | COMPENSATION           | LOCATION                  | STATUS                                                                                                    | DATE |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Kyra</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                       | Senior/Staff Product Engineer                                                                                 | —                      | Remote US                 |  Submitted, no reply   | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to n@kyra.health · delivered; no bounce · engineers.kyra.health                                  |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Lantern</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                    | Junior Software Engineer                                                                                      | —                      | Manhattan · 4d/wk         |  Submitted, no reply   | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to maksym@withlantern.com 7/24 · resent 7/26 · counted once · careers.moxxie.vc                  |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>LightSight</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                 | Forward Deployed Software Engineer                                                                            | —                      | Remote US · travel        |  Submitted, no reply   | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to contact@lightsight.ai · delivered; no bounce · lightsight.ai                                  |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Lumen Energy</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small> | Product Engineer                                                                                              | —                      | Remote                    |  Confirmed received    | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Solar/battery climatetech · Ashby confirmation 7/24 · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                        |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Mastra</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>       | Product Engineer                                                                                              | —                      | Remote worldwide          |  Confirmed received    | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | TypeScript agent framework · Ashby confirmation 7/24 — if fit, recruiter call is next step · jobs.ashbyhq.com |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Mavenly</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                    | Founding Engineer, Full-Stack                                                                                 | \$170–210K + 0.75–1.5% | Atlanta / Remote US       |  Submitted, no reply   | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to careers@mavenly.ai · delivered; no bounce · mavenly.ai                                        |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Onboarded</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>    | Product Engineer, full-stack                                                                                  | —                      | Global remote             |  Confirmed received    | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Applied via Lever · Lever confirmation 7/24 · jobs.lever.co                                                   |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Ondo Finance</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small> | Full-Stack Software Engineer                                                                                  | Competitive            | Remote US                 |  Confirmed received    | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Greenhouse confirmation received · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                   |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>OnePay</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>       | Design Engineer                                                                                               | \$130–160K             | Fully remote              |  Confirmed received    | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | React Native · Ashby confirmation 7/24 · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                                     |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Ontix</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                      | Technical Product Manager                                                                                     | —                      | Remote US                 |  Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to l33t@ontix.io · delivered; no bounce · ontix.io                                               |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>OpenEd</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>       | Product Engineer                                                                                              | —                      | —                         |  Confirmed received  | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | ⚠ Backers still unverified — sanity-check before investing more · Ashby confirmation 7/24 · jobs.ashbyhq.com  |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Pax Historia</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>               | Founding Engineer (Full Stack Web)                                                                            | \$150–215K + 0.25–1%   | San Francisco · in-person |  Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to careers@paxhistoria.co · delivered; no bounce · ycombinator.com                               |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Puma Browser</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>               | AI/ML Engineer                                                                                                | —                      | Remote-first              |  Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to careers+ai@pumabrowser.com · delivered; no bounce · puma.tech                                 |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Resend</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>       | Product Engineer                                                                                              | \$151–170K             | Fully remote              |  Confirmed received  | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Ashby confirmation 7/24 — "a real human will review" · resend.com                                             |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Riot IQ</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                    | AI-native Software Engineer                                                                                   | —                      | Seattle / Remote US       |  Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to robertneir@riotiq.com · delivered; no bounce · riotiq.com                                     |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>SalvoHealth</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>  | Software Engineer                                                                                             | \$100–160K             | NYC / Remote US           |  Confirmed received  | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Lever confirmation received · jobs.lever.co                                                                   |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>SecureFlow</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                 | Junior Software Engineer                                                                                      | \$80–110K + 0.1–0.3%   | Remote global             |  Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to Josepbbob@proton.me · delivered; no bounce · secureflow.tech                                  |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Span</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>         | Product Engineer                                                                                              | \$100–200K + eq        | Fully remote              |  Confirmed received  | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Ashby confirmation 7/24 · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                                                    |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |
| <b>Teckfinty</b><br><small>DIRECT EMAIL</small>                  | AI / Agent Engineer                                                                                           | —                      | Remote                    |  Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
|                                                                  | Direct email to recruitment@teckfinty.com · delivered; no bounce · teckfinty.com                              |                        |                           |                                                                                                           |      |

| COMPANY                                                                                                                                                                      | ROLE                     | COMPENSATION    | LOCATION     | STATUS                | DATE |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|--------------|-----------------------|------|
| <b>TrueBuilt</b>                                                                                                                                                             | Founding Engineer        | —               | Remote-first | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
| <b>NOT RECORDED</b> Pre-construction platform · no confirmation email yet · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                                         |                          |                 |              |                       |      |
| <b>Vertex</b>                                                                                                                                                                | AI Product Engineer      | \$101–136K      | Remote US    | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/24 |
| <b>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</b> Was in backlog — applied via Workday · mention HN to Paul Chung if contacted · Workday confirmation 7/24 · vertexinc.wd1.myworkdayjobs.com |                          |                 |              |                       |      |
| <b>Wheelhouse</b>                                                                                                                                                            | Full Stack Engineer      | —               | Remote-first | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/24 |
| <b>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</b> React/Next/TS + dataviz · Greenhouse confirmation 7/24 · job-boards.greenhouse.io                                                          |                          |                 |              |                       |      |
| <b>Wildflower Health</b>                                                                                                                                                     | Junior Software Engineer | —               | Remote US    | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
| <b>DIRECT EMAIL</b> Direct email to chris.reath@wildflowerhealth.com · delivered; exact role now archived · wildflowerhealth.com                                             |                          |                 |              |                       |      |
| <b>Yuzu</b>                                                                                                                                                                  | Product Engineer         | \$140–265K + eq | NYC · 5d/wk  | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/24 |
| <b>DIRECT EMAIL</b> Direct email to kev@yuzu.health; OOO redirected to ryan@yuzu.health · counted once · yuzu.health                                                         |                          |                 |              |                       |      |

## JULY 23, 2026 — 7 VERIFIED

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------|------|
| <b>AgentPress</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Full-Stack AI Engineer              | —                      | Remote US/Canada             | ✅ Confirmed received | 7/23 |
| <b>DIRECT EMAIL</b> Direct email to apply@agent.press · automated receipt used legacy Emerge Haus branding · agent.press                                                                                                             |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |
| <b>Airtable</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Design Technologist                 | \$224–317.2K           | NYC / SF hybrid 2–3d/wk      | ❌ Rejected           | 7/23 |
| <b>NOT RECORDED</b> Confirmation from jobs@airtable.com 7/23 · Gem rejection 7/28 — “move forward with other candidates whose experience more closely aligns with our team’s needs” · airtable.com                                   |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |
| <b>Aqua Voice</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Design Engineer                     | \$130–210K + eq/bonus  | NYC / SF on-site             | ✅ Confirmed received | 7/23 |
| <b>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</b> Restored 7/24 audit — Ashby confirmation 7/23 (received twice) · six solo products + ThreadKeep pitch · aquavoice.com                                                                              |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |
| <b>Ashby</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Junior Design Engineer, Americas    | \$122–220K + eq        | Remote US                    | ✅ Confirmed received | 7/23 |
| <b>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</b> Was in backlog — applied 7/23 · Ashby confirmation received (found in Gmail) · ashbyhq.com                                                                                                         |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |
| <b>Gumloop</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Design Engineer                     | —                      | NYC / SF / Vancouver on-site | ✅ Confirmed received | 7/23 |
| <b>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</b> Restored 7/24 audit — Ashby confirmation 7/23 · agent-legibility pitch · confirmed NYC office availability · gumloop.com                                                                           |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |
| <b>Pace</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Design Engineer (first design hire) | Competitive + early eq | NYC on-site                  | ✅ Confirmed received | 7/23 |
| <b>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</b> Restored 7/24 audit — Ashby confirmation 7/23 · first Design Engineer · WPCNA maps 1:1 · \$46M Series B insurance AI · jobs.ashbyhq.com                                                            |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |
| <b>Rillet</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Design Engineer                     | \$150–240K             | NYC / SF hybrid              | ❌ Rejected           | 7/23 |
| <b>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</b> Ashby rejection 7/27 — “moving forward with other candidates,” invited to reapply as new roles open · Ashby confirmation 7/23 · full arc concept → shipped · AI-native design-to-code · rillet.com |                                     |                        |                              |                      |      |

## JULY 22, 2026 — 18 VERIFIED

|                                                                                                               |                                 |                   |                    |                       |      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------|-----------------------|------|
| <b>Credal.ai</b>                                                                                              | Founding Design Engineer        | \$170–230K + eq   | Brooklyn, on-site  | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/22 |
| <b>DIRECT EMAIL</b> Follow-up emailed to Ravin (CEO) · credal.ai                                              |                                 |                   |                    |                       |      |
| <b>Dimely</b>                                                                                                 | Founding Engineer, Full Stack   | \$100–140K + 1–3% | Remote / Hybrid SF | ✅ Confirmed received  | 7/22 |
| <b>YC BOARD</b> Dover confirmation — the “lost form” actually went through · YC S24, 4th hire · usedimely.com |                                 |                   |                    |                       |      |
| <b>Fifth Door</b>                                                                                             | Front End Engineer — games + AI | — + eq            | Remote US 🐶        | 📧 Submitted, no reply | 7/22 |
| <b>NOT RECORDED</b> Daniel · Ad Arma maps 1:1 — strongest-fit pitch of the run · fifthdoor.com                |                                 |                   |                    |                       |      |



| COMPANY                                                       | ROLE                                                                                                                                                                        | COMPENSATION                   | LOCATION                | STATUS                   | DATE |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|------|
| <b>Finta</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                   | Founding Designer (employee #3)<br>Andy · designs-in-code pitch · portfolio-review interview · finta.com                                                                    | \$140–220K + 1–5%              | SF / Remote 🐶           | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Git AI</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                  | Founding Engineer<br>Pitch sent direct to founder (Aidan) · alternate Gmail draft is dead — delete · usegitai.com                                                           | \$190–220K + eq                | NYC in-person           | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Hera</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                    | Founding Product Designer<br>Peter (CEO) · "slope not intercept" · hera.video                                                                                               | €80–130K + eq                  | Berlin pref / NY remote | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Humwork</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                 | Founding Engineer<br>Email to founders@ (their preferred channel) · they reply within 48h — watch inbox · humwork.ai                                                        | \$120–150K + 2.5–10%           | SF in-person            | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Infisical</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>               | Developer Advocate<br>Tony · teaching/translation pitch · 7/24: they viewed Mike's LinkedIn — worth a look at their other openings · infisical.com                          | \$120–190K                     | Remote US/CA            | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Infisical</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>               | Design Engineer, Brand<br>Double-apply flagged as intentional · infisical.com                                                                                               | \$100–180K                     | Remote US/CA            | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Nixo</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                    | Founding Member of Technical Staff<br>Priya · WPCNA deployment-mess story · ycombinator.com                                                                                 | \$150–250K + eq                | Remote US               | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Novig</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                   | AI Automation Engineer<br>Gambling domain — ignore any reply · novig.com                                                                                                    | \$200–230K                     | NYC                     | ✅ Confirmed received     | 7/22 |
| <b>Onlook</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                  | Founding Engineer — "Cursor for Designers"<br>Daniel · "the user Onlook exists for" pitch · onlook.com                                                                      | \$130–200K + eq                | Remote US 🐶             | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Pillar</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                  | Founding Designer<br>Creator-economy suite · "I was your user for 20 years" · ycombinator.com                                                                               | —                              | Remote US 🐶             | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>ProhostAI</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>               | Founding Engineer, Full Stack<br>Bill · Airbnb/Dropbox founders · honest-gap pitch · prohost.ai                                                                             | \$100–180K + eq                | Remote US               | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Rivet</b><br><small>WEB FORM</small>                       | Full Stack Engineer (early team)<br>Google Form recorded · AI direct-to-fan platform for artists · favorite band: Tool · rivet.app                                          | Not posted — quoted \$110–140K | Remote US 🐶             | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Scott AI</b><br><small>YC BOARD</small>                    | Design Engineer<br>YC F25 · planning layer for coding-agent teams · Metro-North commutable · tryscott.ai                                                                    | \$140–250K + 0.5–1.5%          | NYC / SF office         | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>The Company Company</b><br><small>YC BOARD</small>         | Founding Design Engineer<br>Julius · 1-person YC P26 · watch WaaS inbox · workatastartup.com                                                                                | \$130–200K + eq                | Remote US               | 📁 Submitted, no reply    | 7/22 |
| <b>Tsenta</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>    | Founding Engineer<br>Applied via Ashby · live conversation — the only human contact so far · tsenta.com                                                                     | —                              | Remote US               | 🟢 <u>A human engaged</u> | 7/22 |
| <b>JULY 21, 2026 — 5 VERIFIED</b>                             |                                                                                                                                                                             |                                |                         |                          |      |
| <b>Anthropic</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small> | Design Engineer, Web<br>Greenhouse confirmation · timeline is Feb 2026 — never say two years · anthropic.com                                                                | \$260–305K                     | Remote, 25% office      | ✅ Confirmed received     | 7/21 |
| <b>GitHub</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small>    | Design Engineer III (Req 5478)<br>iCIMS rejection 7/23 — reviewed by a Talent Partner, "moving forward with other candidates" · first decision of the campaign · github.com | \$153.9–285.9K                 | Remote                  | ❌ Rejected               | 7/21 |



| COMPANY                                                    | ROLE                                                                                                                                    | COMPENSATION    | LOCATION            | STATUS                                                                                                        | DATE |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Luma AI</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>              | Forward Deployed Creative [US]<br>Gem confirmation received · lumalabs.ai                                                               | \$150–200K      | NY / LA / PA office |  <b>Confirmed received</b> | 7/21 |
| <b>OpenAI</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>               | Model Designer, Core Models<br>Their system parsed first name as "White" (autofill glitch) — correct casually if contacted · openai.com | \$266–295K + eq | SF hybrid 3d/wk     |  <b>Confirmed received</b> | 7/21 |
| <b>Runway</b><br><small>COMPANY APPLICATION SYSTEM</small> | Design Engineer, Runway Labs<br>Ashby confirmation · earlier 7/7 email to recruiting@ = same application · runwayml.com                 | \$250–310K      | Remote              |  <b>Confirmed received</b> | 7/21 |
| <b>JULY 14, 2026 — 1 VERIFIED</b>                          |                                                                                                                                         |                 |                     |                                                                                                               |      |
| <b>Hugging Face</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>         | Wild Card application<br>The one that started the campaign · Workable confirmation · fresh anchor application queued · huggingface.co   | —               | Remote              |  <b>Confirmed received</b> | 7/14 |
| <b>JULY 7, 2026 — 6 VERIFIED</b>                           |                                                                                                                                         |                 |                     |                                                                                                               |      |
| <b>Arize</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                | Open Source Design Engineer<br>No reply · arize.com                                                                                     | —               | —                   |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/7  |
| <b>Collier.Simon</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>        | Creative Technologist<br>One thread (original + 2 corrections) · no reply · colliersimon.com                                            | —               | —                   |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/7  |
| <b>Felt</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>                 | Spatial tools / creative technologist<br>"Application received" auto-ack · felt.com                                                     | —               | —                   |  <b>Confirmed received</b> | 7/7  |
| <b>Lightning Labs</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>       | AI Product Engineer<br>No reply · lightning.engineering                                                                                 | —               | —                   |  Submitted, no reply       | 7/7  |
| <b>Scenario</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>             | Creative Technologist<br>Canned ack only (29s after send) · scenario.com                                                                | —               | —                   |  Submitted, no reply      | 7/7  |
| <b>USB Club / garden3d</b><br><small>NOT RECORDED</small>  | Part-time Design Engineer<br>Sent to Hugh · no reply · garden3d.net                                                                     | —               | —                   |  Submitted, no reply     | 7/7  |

# Appendix — plain-language glossary

*Extracted from the live tracker so the paper and the website always say the same thing.*

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## HOW AN APPLICATION TRAVELS

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**ATS** *also: applicant tracking system, applicant tracking systems*

The software a company uses to collect and sort applications. Ashby, Greenhouse, Lever, Workday and iCIMS are the ones that turn up most often on this page.

**ATS confirmation** *also: automated confirmation, confirmation email, application confirmation, application receipt*

The automatic email their system sends the moment an application lands. It proves the file arrived; it does not mean a person has opened it.

**portal** *also: portals, candidate portal, application portal*

A company's own web page where you type in your history and upload a résumé instead of emailing anyone. Most of them make you retype everything that is already on the résumé you just attached.

**req** *also: reqs, requisition, requisitions, job requisition*

The internal ticket saying a company has the budget to pay one more person, usually with a number attached. No req, no job — even if the posting is still up.

**autoresponder** *also: auto-reply, autoreply, auto-ack, canned ack, automated receipt, automatic reply*

A pre-written reply that fires the second your message arrives, sometimes within seconds. It tells you the machine is working, and nothing about your chances.

**no-reply** *also: noreply, no-reply address, do-not-reply, donotreply*

An address that can send mail but cannot receive it, so answering it goes nowhere. To reach an actual person you have to find their real address yourself.

**bounced** *also: bounce, bounces, bounced back, hard bounce*

The message never reached anyone — the address was wrong or dead and the mail system sent it back. Notes here that say “no bounce” mean the opposite: it arrived.

**cold email** *also: cold emails, cold outreach, cold emailed, cold-emailed*

Writing straight to someone at a company that never posted the job you want. It is not rude, and at small companies it is often how hiring actually starts.

**referral** *also: referrals, referred, internal referral*

Someone inside the company passes your name along, which lifts you out of the pile and in front of a human. It is the biggest single advantage in hiring, and the main reason two people with the same experience get very different results.

## WHO YOU ARE TALKING TO

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**recruiter** *also: recruiters, in-house recruiter*

The person whose job is to find candidates and move them through the steps. They are not the one who decides, and they are usually juggling dozens of openings at once.

**Talent Partner** *also: talent partners, talent acquisition partner, talent acquisition*

A recruiter with a warmer job title. Same work: finding people, booking calls, and sending the yes or the no.

**agency** *also: agencies, recruiting agency, staffing agency, agency recruiter, external recruiter*

An outside firm that finds candidates for other companies and is paid only when someone is hired. They can be genuinely helpful, but the company is the one paying them, not you.

**hiring manager** *also: hiring managers*

The person you would actually work for, and the one who decides. Everyone before them is a filter.

**hotlist** *also: hot list, talent pool, talent community*

A list of people a company says it will remember when something opens up. Saying it costs them nothing, and almost nobody is ever contacted from one.

## STAGES

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**Submitted** *also: submitted, no reply*

Sent, and nothing has come back — no receipt, no rejection, not a word. This is where most rows on this page sit.

**Submitted ✓** *also: confirmed received*

Their system sent back a receipt, so the application is known to have arrived. The mark shows where a row stands today, so two applications that later turned into a rejection or a conversation no longer carry it.

**screen** *also: phone screen, recruiter screen, screening call, initial screen*

A short first call, usually twenty or thirty minutes with a recruiter, to check the basics. It is a gate, not really an interview.

**take-home** *also: take home, take-home assignment, take-home project, take home test*

A piece of real work you do alone, on your own time, unpaid, and send back. Reasonable ones take an evening; unreasonable ones eat a weekend.

**loop** *also: interview loop, onsite loop, final loop, onsite interviews*

The final round: several interviews back to back, often in one day, with different people. Afterwards they compare notes and decide together.

**Conversation** *also: live conversation, live conversations, conversations*

A real person wrote back and a genuine back-and-forth started. It is the rarest status on this page.

**Rejected** *also: rejection, rejections, declined, passed on*

They said no. Sometimes it arrives as a form letter, occasionally as a real note from a real person.

**in pipeline** *also: pipeline, in the pipeline*

Applications still alive in some form — sent, confirmed, or being talked about — with no final answer yet. Silence keeps a row here until it is plainly dead.

**backlog** *also: in backlog, moved from backlog*

Jobs worth applying to that have not gone out yet. Keeping them separate is what stops good intentions from being counted as work done.

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## MONEY AND OWNERSHIP

**base** *also: base salary, base pay*

The cash salary, before anything else is added on. It is the only part you can actually count on.

**equity** *also: eq, equity grant, ownership stake*

A slice of ownership in the company, handed over instead of some of the cash. It is worth nothing unless the company is later sold or goes public.

**options** *also: stock options, share options, option grant*

The right to buy company shares later at a price fixed today. If the company grows you buy cheap; if it does not, you simply never buy.

**vesting** *also: vest, vests, vested, vesting schedule*

You earn your equity gradually, month by month, rather than receiving it on day one. Leave early and you keep only the part you have earned so far.

**cliff** *also: one-year cliff, 1-year cliff, vesting cliff*

A waiting period, usually a full year, before any equity is yours at all. Leave a day before it and you walk away with none of it.

**OTE** *also: on-target earnings, on target earnings*

Salary plus the bonus you would earn if you hit every target. Read it as the best case, not as the offer.

**comp** *also: compensation, total comp, comp package, total compensation*

Everything you are paid — salary, bonus, equity and benefits — added into one number. Companies quote the big total; the cash part is the part that pays rent.

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## WHERE WORK HAPPENS

**Remote** *also: remote US, fully remote, remote-first, remote global, remote worldwide, work from home*

You work from where you live. Read the fine print — remote usually still means a particular country, and often specific hours overlapping someone else's day.

**Hybrid** *also: hybrid schedule, part remote*

Some days in the office, the rest at home, with the split set by the company rather than by you. Listings here spell it out, like three days a week.

**On-site** *also: onsite, in-person, in person, in the office*

You are expected in the building, most days or every day. For these jobs that usually means living near New York or San Francisco.

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## ROLE TITLES

**Design Engineer** *also: design engineers, design technologist, creative technologist*

Someone who designs how a thing looks and behaves, then writes the code that makes it real. Some companies call the same job design technologist or creative technologist.

**Founding Engineer** *also: founding engineers, founding design engineer, founding designer, founding member of technical staff, member of technical staff*

One of the first few people building the product, before there are teams, managers or process. More ownership and more equity, with no guarantee the company lasts.

**Product Engineer** *also: product engineers*

An engineer trusted to decide what to build, not only how to build it, working close to the people who use it. The opposite of being handed a finished spec.

**Full-Stack** *also: full stack, fullstack, full-stack engineer, full stack engineer, full-stack developer*

Able to work on the part people see and the machinery behind it. At a small company it usually just means everything.

## STARTUP VOCABULARY

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**YC** *also: Y Combinator, YCombinator*

Y Combinator, the best known startup program: it gives brand-new companies a little money and three months of coaching in exchange for a piece of them. Tags like S24 or F25 say which batch a company came through.

**WaaS** *also: Work at a Startup*

Work at a Startup, Y Combinator's own job board for the companies it has funded. A few of the applications here went out through it.

**accelerator** *also: accelerators, startup accelerator, incubator*

A short program that funds a group of new companies, coaches them, and ends with them pitching investors. Y Combinator is the famous one.

**Ashby**

One of the systems companies use to take in applications, common at startups. Its automatic receipt is what puts the check mark on many rows here.

**Greenhouse**

Another widely used application system, more common at bigger companies. Its receipt sometimes leaves the job title out, which is why a couple of rows here say the role was not stated.

**iCIMS**

An older application system, used mostly by large established employers. It produced the first rejection of this campaign.

**Polymer**

A smaller, newer application system used by one company on this list. Same purpose as the rest: take applications in and sort them.

## WHAT THE POLITE PHRASES ACTUALLY MEAN

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**moving forward with other candidates** *also: move forward with other candidates, moving forward with others, decided to move forward with other candidates, pursuing other candidates*

This is a no. It is the standard phrasing for a rejection, and it does not mean a decision is still open.

**not a great fit** *also: not a fit, not a good fit, not the right fit, not quite the right fit, not a fit for the current role*

Also a no, usually a kind one. It rarely means anything specific about you, and asking what was missing almost never gets an answer.

**keep you on our hotlist** *also: keeping him on their hotlist, keeping you on our hotlist, on our hotlist, keep you on file, keep your resume on file, keep your résumé on file*

A gentle way to end things without saying never. It costs nothing to say and rarely leads anywhere, so treat it as a no with the door left ajar.

**we'll be in touch** *also: we'll be in touch, we will be in touch, we'll be in touch soon, be in touch*

On its own, this means nothing. With a date or a named next step attached it is real; without one, expect silence.

**reach out** *also: reach back out, reaching out, we'll reach out, we'll reach out*

Office language for “get in touch”. When they say they will reach out, no promise has been made; when you do it yourself, it is the part of a job hunt that actually works.

**circle back** *also: circling back, circle back with you, come back to you*

To return to something later. In hiring it nearly always means no decision is being made today, and often none is ever made.